Netanyahu is something of a puzzle. He is dogged by corruption scandals and full to the brim of himself, but far from dumb. Moreover, he doesn't care about ideology, only about power and the good life. Could it be that in order to escape indictments that would have probably turned into minor plea deals, he is ready to become the destroyer of Israel?

American Jewry may be splitting along the same fault lines as Israeli society. The biggest supporters of Netanyahu and his zealots are the Trumpists and, particularly, the Evangelicals, who align their politics with their theological convictions. Hidden from view are the billionaires of Forum Kohelet. A dangerous coalition. It so happens, though, that the chief economist of Kohelet has doubts about the Israeli judicial overhaul because of its negative economic consequences.

Israeli women form human chains to protest the judicial overhaul.

## *Thursday, March 9*

Many of the demonstrations are led by high-ranking reserve officers. Six were arrested for preventing access to the Kohelet offices in Jerusalem, more arrests than for the hooligans in Huwara … The Ayalon Highway to and from Tel Aviv was blocked for several hours. Now the seashore road is barred. The voice of protest is heard clear and loud. Netanyahu, who arrived at the airport in a police helicopter, declared to the Italian media that the protests show the strength of democracy in Israel. The man is a shameless stand-up comedian.

On Ben-Gvir's orders, Amihai Eshed, commander of the Tel Aviv police, has been moved to another position. Ben-Gvir targeted Eshed because of his lenient attitude toward the demonstrators.

In an unprecedented show of resolve, President Herzog, in a speech to the nation, came out against the judicial overhaul. He told Knesset members that they were responsible for the spreading chaos. He is calling for an